- Cut with long, smooth strokes. Keep the cutting blade or shear resting on the table.
- Cut notches outward.
- Check if extra pattern details like bias binding, facing, piping are cut.

After cutting the patterns, place them carefully together. Don't fold the patterns. Try to sew the patterns together as soon as possible because delay in sewing will reduce the freshness of the garment.

11.7 PATTERN LAYOUT

The placement of pattern on the fabric, in an economical manner, that is without wasting fabric is known as pattern layout. All the patterns should be arranged properly following grain of the fabric. Example the bodice centre front will be in straight (lengthwise direction) grain.

The main points to be considered while laying patterns are:

- Press the fabric without any wrinkles before laying the patterns.
- Place the fabric on a large or a hard flat surface, which is easy for work.
- Place the larger patterns first. Place similar pattern together, with same length. Example placement of bodice front and bodices back next to each other, such that the side seams are close to each other.
- Place the smaller patterns in gaps in between the larger pattern.
- If pattern is to be cut in more number, example two sleeve patterns, place them on fold. This concept is not possible when the fabric has a one way design or when the patterns have different front and back patterns.
- Keep weight, pencil, pins ready in hand, to draw, or pin or place weights on patterns, so that it remains in correct position.

11.7.1 Types of Pattern Layouts

Based upon the placement of the patterns, the layouts are classified as

- Open layout.
- Lengthwise centre fold.
- Off-centre length wise fold.
- Crosswise centre fold.
- Off centre crosswise fold.
- Double fold or combination fold .

Open Layout

Open layout is the simplest layout. The fabric is spread on the table and the patterns are laid from left to right one after the other. This is easy for beginners. No fold is made in this method. It can be used for all patterns. This is used especially for designs with different left and right patterns.

Lengthwise Centre Fold

The fabric is folded in the lengthwise direction. The selvedges of both sides are placed one on top of the other and folded in the middle. The fabric forms a fold at the centre. All folded patterns are placed along this fold. This fold is also used for different type of frocks, shirts and blouses.

Off-Centre Lengthwise Fold

The required width needed for the patterns is taken on the fabric and folded in the lengthwise direction. This is commonly seen when many small patterns are found

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